

MEETING ROOM MANAGER - RISK REGISTER

1) Exchange Online PowerShell module / auth changes

Risk: Microsoft changes the supported Exchange Online PowerShell connection or module behaviour in a way that affects current cmdlets, parameters, or authentication flow. Your script relies on Connect-ExchangeOnline, the ExchangeOnlineManagement module, and REST-backed cmdlets rather than legacy RPS. Microsoft has already permanently retired Remote PowerShell for Exchange Online and states all tenants must use the REST-based v3 module; Microsoft also documents that REST connections require supporting modules such as PowerShellGet and PackageManagement.

Trigger examples:

- ExchangeOnlineManagement major-version behaviour change
- auth UX changes around Web Account Manager / browser sign-in / modern auth
- supporting dependency issues in PowerShellGet / PackageManagement on the client.

Impact: The tool may fail to connect at startup, fail to import the module, or behave inconsistently when running EXO commands even though the script itself has not changed. Because the script checks/install the module at runtime and then immediately connects, this is a **front-door failure risk**.

Risk level: High. Exchange Online administration is a cloud dependency and Microsoft actively evolves the EXO module/auth stack.

Mitigation:

- pin and test the ExchangeOnlineManagement version used in production before broad rollout
- keep a regression test workbook and run a smoke test after module updates
- avoid any future use of -UseRPSSession, New-PSSession, or old EXO module patterns.

2) PIM / JIT / Conditional Access drift

Risk: Changes to **Microsoft Entra PIM** or Conditional Access settings can prevent operators from activating the Exchange Administrator role when needed, or can shorten/complicate privileged sessions enough that the tool fails mid-run. Microsoft documents that PIM role settings can enforce MFA, approval, activation duration limits, and Conditional Access authentication context requirements per role. Your final banner already assumes Exchange Administrator JIT must be active before use.

Trigger examples:

- MFA becomes mandatory on activation

- approval workflow is introduced
- activation duration is reduced
- Conditional Access authentication context or compliant-device requirement is added
- sign-in frequency/token protection makes activation harder during operational use.

Impact: Operators may be unable to activate the necessary role, may lose the role before a long run finishes, or may successfully connect but lose permission to run part of the workflow. This is especially relevant because the script performs multiple Exchange operations in sequence and does not re-request privilege during execution.

Risk level: High. This is one of the most likely organisational-change break points because it can be caused by internal security-policy updates rather than code changes.

Mitigation:

- document the minimum required PIM activation duration for a full create/modify/check run
- align PIM approval/MFA/CA policy with operational support procedures
- maintain at least one break-glass or emergency admin path for tool support.

3) Windows PowerShell 5.1 dependency

Risk: The script hard-requires **Windows PowerShell 5.1** and explicitly throws if another major version is used. Microsoft documents that Windows PowerShell 5.1 support is tied to the Windows lifecycle, while modern PowerShell development investment is in PowerShell 7.x. If your environment standardises on pwsh/PowerShell 7, suppresses powershell.exe, or changes endpoint standards away from Windows PowerShell, the tool will not run unchanged.

Trigger examples:

- engineering standard changes to PowerShell 7 only
- endpoint hardening removes or restricts powershell.exe
- future Windows lifecycle or enterprise baselines deprioritise Windows PowerShell use.

Impact: Immediate startup failure because the script explicitly checks for PowerShell 5.x only. This is a **hard compatibility gate**, not a degraded-mode scenario.

Risk level: Medium–High. Windows PowerShell 5.1 is still supported through Windows support channels, so this is not an imminent Microsoft shutdown risk, but it is a real **enterprise platform drift** risk.

Mitigation:

- retain Windows PowerShell 5.1 on support/admin workstations for this tool
- explicitly document “PowerShell 5.1 Desktop only” in the runbook

- if long-term maintenance is expected, plan a future PowerShell 7 compatibility review.
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4) Excel desktop COM dependency

Risk: Workbook import depends on **Excel COM automation** (New-Object -ComObject Excel.Application). If Excel desktop is not installed, is broken, is blocked by policy, or COM automation becomes unavailable on the admin endpoint, workbook import fails. The script does not use a library-based Excel parser; it automates the desktop application.

Trigger examples:

- Microsoft 365 Apps / Excel removed from support workstation image
- Office repair/update breaks local COM registration
- DCOM / COM launch permissions tightened on hardened endpoints
- endpoint standard changes from desktop Office to web-only workflows.

Impact: Create and Modify effectively stop functioning, because they are workbook-dependent and workbook import cannot start. Delete and Check still have manual fallback modes, but the main provisioning workflow does not.

Risk level: High for create/modify operations. This is one of the strongest single-point dependencies in the tool.

Mitigation:

- keep Excel desktop installed on all support/admin endpoints that run the tool
 - include an Excel COM smoke test in pre-deployment checks
 - long term: consider replacing COM import with a file-library approach if resilience becomes a priority.
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5) Workbook contract drift (non-Microsoft but high operational risk)

Risk: The tool is strongly coupled to the workbook schema and worksheet name. Your final build still hardcodes Add New Meeting Rooms, and Create / Modify remain workbook-dependent. If the template is renamed, required headers change, or field conventions drift, the tool stops working correctly even though the platform is unchanged.

Trigger examples:

- handover team edits worksheet name
- required headers renamed
- floor / approval / delegate conventions change without script change.

Impact: Import failures, blocked rows, or incorrect configuration/check results. This is not a Microsoft deprecation risk, but it is one of the highest **operational** break risks.

Risk level: High operationally.

Mitigation:

- treat the workbook as a controlled template
- protect the header row and worksheet name
- include workbook schema checks in handover and change control.

6) STA requirement /tool incompatible with CLM-enforced endpoints without code signing

Risk: The tool invokes Windows PowerShell in STA (Single-Threaded Apartment) mode, which is required for Excel COM automation. Endpoints enforcing Constrained Language Mode (CLM) — typically laptops, thin clients, and privileged access workstations managed under AppLocker or WDAC policy — block unsigned scripts from running regardless of the execution policy set at the session level. On CLM-enforced endpoints the tool will fail to launch or will run in a restricted language mode that breaks COM object creation and module installation.

Trigger examples:

- operator attempts to run the tool from a CLM-enforced laptop or desktop
- endpoint AppLocker or WDAC policy is tightened to block unsigned .ps1 and .cmd files
- standard desktop fleet is replaced with CLM-enforced endpoints as default workstation

Impact: Complete tool failure on affected endpoints. Because CLM restrictions operate below the script's own execution policy check, the failure occurs before the tool reaches its version guard or module installer. Operators on CLM devices have no workaround without either a signed version of the script or access to an unrestricted standard desktop. This is a hard access gate, not a degraded-mode scenario.

Risk level: Medium. The tool is explicitly documented as STA/standard desktop only, so the scope is bounded by correct deployment practice. Risk escalates to High if the standard desktop fleet is deprecated or CLM becomes the default endpoint configuration.

Mitigation:

- restrict tool deployment to standard non-CLM desktops only; document this requirement explicitly in the runbook and prerequisites
 - if broader endpoint support becomes a requirement, obtain a code-signing certificate from the organisation's PKI and sign both the .ps1 and .cmd files; signed scripts run under CLM without requiring FullLanguage mode
 - as a stopgap, operators on CLM endpoints can remote into a standard desktop to run the tool if one is available.
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